Activity 6 - Deploy the Team and Resolve the Resource Bottleneck

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 6 | Deploy Resources Learning outcome: LO6 Duration: 60 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Organisation Chart, Kanban Board and Project Budget templates

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Objective

Deploy manpower, budget and relevant resources for efficient completion (A6).

The situation

The test plan needs 22 person-days in the next two weeks, but only 16 are available. The same business analyst is assigned to testing, training materials and vendor clarification. The sponsor refuses a launch delay unless the team proves no lower-cost option exists.

What you will do

Map roles and capacity, expose over-allocation, compare smoothing, levelling, crashing and fast tracking, re-sequence work on a Kanban board and recommend a resource decision with cost and risk evidence.

What you will produce

A two-week capacity plan, organisation and escalation map, workload Kanban, evaluated compression options, reconciled budget impact and a sponsor recommendation that removes the bottleneck.

Tool files in this folder

- `tools/40 Organisation Chart.pptx`
- `tools/30 Kanban Board.xlsx`
- `tools/32 Project Budget - Planned vs Actual - Weekly and Monthly.xlsx`

Data files

- `data/resource-capacity.csv`

Step-by-step instructions

1. Open the organisation-chart template and map the sponsor, PM, functional managers, vendor leads and seven-person core team. Show escalation lines separately from work coordination.

2. Create a two-week capacity table by person and skill. Use available person-days, not nominal headcount.

3. Map every near-term work package to skill, effort, owner, earliest start, dependency and due date.

4. Calculate demand minus capacity. Identify the business analyst as the constraint and quantify the six-person-day gap.

5. Open the Kanban template or Scrum browser tool. Create To Do, Ready, In Progress, Review and Done columns and set WIP limits around the analyst's constraint.

6. Test resource smoothing by using float on non-critical tasks. Recalculate the schedule and note whether the project finish changes.

7. Test resource levelling by moving work until demand fits capacity. Record the new finish date and milestone impact.

8. Test crashing by adding a contract analyst to critical-path work. Enter the incremental cost and check whether the saved time justifies it.

9. Test fast tracking by overlapping training-material drafting with late testing. Record the rework and quality risk introduced.

10. Update the project budget with the preferred option. Keep approved changes separate from contingency usage.

11. Recommend one option to the sponsor using four fields: schedule effect, cost effect, risk effect and decision deadline.

12. Define team-working rules for handoffs and conflict: who decides, how blockers are raised, and when the PM escalates.

Evidence to submit

Complete WORKSHEET.md and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

The plan reconciles named work with actual capacity; the bottleneck is visible; each optimisation option has schedule, cost and risk consequences; and the chosen deployment fits the approved project constraints.

Debrief

- A name in a RACI matrix does not create capacity; capacity must be measured against concurrent demand.
- Fast tracking buys time with risk, while crashing buys time with cost-neither is automatically a good decision.
- Manage the constraint first. Adding capacity elsewhere can increase WIP without improving delivery.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 6. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.